PUBLIC POLICIES & GOVERNANCE SOCIETY · HALDIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

Building a student organisation that could run without me

How a new campus chapter was founded, staffed, funded through local sponsorship, and handed over to a self-running team inside one academic year.

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Role
Co-founder · President 2026–27

Period covered
2025–26 academic year



Debatocracy, Annex Building, HIT Haldia · 13 September 2025

01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What this is

In 2025, Haldia Institute of Technology had no student body dedicated to public policy, debate, or structured public speaking. I co-founded the HIT chapter of the Public Policies and Governance Society (PPGS), a society originally run at IIT Kharagpur, and took responsibility for building and running it on the ground.

Over the following academic year I recruited the founding team, allocated roles by individual strength, ran the society single-handedly for roughly a month when contributors went quiet, negotiated sponsorship with two local businesses, delivered two competitive events, represented the college externally at IIT Kharagpur, designed a recruitment campaign after being refused classroom access, and then trained and handed the operation to the year below me.

The outcome I care most about is the last one. The society now runs a three-layer workflow across academic years and publishes without my involvement in every task. My current role is oversight, not execution.

2	2	₹10,000	~150	~40	1
Competitive events delivered end-to-end	External business partnerships secured	Direct cash sponsorship, plus one in-kind deal	Applicants to the recruitment drive	Members across academic years today	Institutional representation, IIT Kharagpur
OFFICIAL REPORT	INTERNAL RECORDS	INTERNAL RECORDS	INTERNAL RECORDS	INTERNAL RECORDS	OFFICIAL REPORT

What I want a reader to take from this

I did not inherit a functioning organisation. There was no member list, no budget, no faculty relationship and no precedent. Everything described here started from nothing.

I did not do all of it. Where the work belonged to someone else, this document says so by name. Section 12 separates my contribution from the team's explicitly.

The numbers are labelled, not laundered. Some figures come from the society's official report; others come only from my own records. Where the two disagree, the disagreement is printed rather than resolved silently. See the key below and the data notes on the final page.

REPORT Documented in the official PPGS Report v1.4, submitted to the institute.

INTERNAL My own records and recollection. Not independently documented.

VISUAL Supported by event photographs, posters or published posts.

02 · STARTING POSITION

The gap, and the opening

Why the society was worth starting, and why the opportunity was time-limited.

The gap on campus

HIT Haldia has an active club culture: technical societies, cultural societies, an alumni club. What it did not have was a forum where students argued a position, defended it under pressure, and were judged on it. Political and public-policy awareness among students was low, and there was no structured route into it.

That produced a specific, unmet need rather than a vague one: students who wanted to build confidence in speaking, reasoning and public affairs had nowhere to practise, and students preparing for UPSC or civil-services careers had no mentorship channel inside the college.

The opening

PPGS already existed and functioned at IIT Kharagpur, including mentorship for UPSC and government examination preparation. A chapter model meant we would not have to invent a curriculum, a name, or credibility from scratch, but it also meant the IIT Kharagpur team had to be convinced that a Haldia chapter would not embarrass them.

> **THE ACTUAL CONSTRAINT**
>
> The permission was not ours to assume. Approval depended on persuading an external team, with no prior relationship, that two students at another institution could operate their brand responsibly. That conversation, not the paperwork, was the real first task.

Timeline of the year covered

Mid 2025	**Chapter founded**	Approach to the IIT Kharagpur PPGS team, plan presented, permission granted. Subid Thakur (4th year) as founder, myself (3rd year) as co-founder. INTERNAL
Mid–late 2025	**Founding team recruited**	Roughly 14 third-year students brought in and assigned functions by strength. INTERNAL
13 Sept 2025	**Debatocracy: debate competition**	First event. Faculty judges. Three winners. Registration fee ₹9. REPORT VISUAL
Late 2025	**Contribution collapse and recovery**	Contributors went quiet under academic load; I ran operations directly for roughly a month, then trained replacements. Two members removed for non-contribution. INTERNAL
21–22 Mar 2026	**Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur**	Selected via Unstop; represented PPGS and HIT off campus. REPORT VISUAL
29 Mar 2026	**Voice of Ideas: extempore competition**	Second event. Judged by club members. Three winners. Registration fee ₹19. ₹10,000 sponsorship. REPORT VISUAL
2026	**Recruitment drive and handover**	Instagram-led recruitment after classroom access was refused; interviews conducted; operations delegated to the year below. INTERNAL
2026–27	**Core committee formalised**	Twelve-member core committee constituted; I hold the President position. REPORT

Sequencing note: my own recollection placed the IIT Kharagpur representation after Voice of Ideas. The official report dates it 21–22 March 2026 and Voice of Ideas 29 March 2026. The report's dates are used above.

03 · BUILDING THE TEAM

Recruiting into a society that had no track record

The hardest sell was not the events. It was getting good people to commit before there was any proof it would work.

The objection I had to answer

Every capable student I wanted was already in another club. Joining PPGS meant a second set of meetings, a second set of deadlines, and no visible reward. The honest objection was: *why add work to my week for something that does not exist yet?*

I did not answer that with enthusiasm. I answered it with what the role would actually give them:

- **Ownership, not membership.** In an established club they would be one of fifty. Here they would own a function outright, from the first day.
- **Access.** Direct contact with the IIT Kharagpur PPGS team and their mentors, which no other club at HIT offered.
- **A first mover's record.** Something on their record they built rather than joined.

Channels used: personal network, direct one-to-one conversations, word of mouth, classroom promotion where permitted, and a promotional video. I already had visibility on campus from prior society and event involvement, which lowered the cost of the first conversations. Some students approached us without being asked.

STRUCTURAL PROBLEM I HAD TO ABSORB

Subid recruited several fourth-year students so the society had senior names attached to it. Those students were in the middle of placements. The names gave the chapter standing; they could not give it hours. Execution therefore fell to me as the senior-most available operator, in my third year.

Allocating roles by strength, not by rank

I did not hand out identical jobs. I mapped what each person was already good at onto a function the society needed, so that the first thing they did was something they could already do well.

PERSON	WHY THEY WERE PLACED THERE	FUNCTION OWNED (TITLE IN 2026–27 COMMITTEE)
Anshu Raj	All-round execution ability; could cover most functions if I was unavailable	Deputy across operations (Vice President)
Avinash Kumar	Strong personal network; good at handling a room	Coordination and audience (Secretary)
Anand Kumar	Knew local business owners; already active in the alumni club	Sponsorship and guest outreach (Alumni & Sponsorship Head)
Amrita Kumari	Graphic design	Posters and event collateral (Joint Secretary)
Dhruv Raj	Both design and video; the only one who could coordinate across both	Media coordination (GD Head)
Alysha	Video editing	Video production (Video Head)
Adnan Khan	Video and content	Content production (Content Head)
Anwesha Kumari	Trusted with money; disciplined record-keeping	Fees, sponsorship funds, event spend (Treasurer)
Deepak Raj	Willing to chase approvals in person across departments	Event execution (Event Head)
Shivam Kumar	Same; good at getting people into a room	Permissions and turnout (PR Head)
Vishal Kumar	Research habit; could find debatable material	Topic and content research (Research Head)

Titles in the right-hand column are as recorded in the official PPGS Report v1.4 core committee for 2026–27. **REPORT** Role rationale is my own account. **INTERNAL**



Reconciliation: roughly fourteen third-year students were recruited; two were later removed for non-contribution; the official 2026–27 core committee lists twelve members.

04 · MANAGING PEOPLE

The month the team stopped, and two removals

Two decisions that were genuinely uncomfortable, and what each of them cost.

Problem 1: contribution collapsed after the first month

The chapter ran cleanly for about a month: consistent posting, visible activity, growing internal momentum. Then academic pressure hit the third-year batch and most contributors went quiet at roughly the same time. Nobody resigned. The work simply stopped arriving.

A new organisation that goes silent in its first term does not usually recover, because there is no habit or reputation holding it up. So I took the work over directly and ran the society largely on my own for approximately a month: posting, coordination, follow-ups, permissions.

> **THE DECISION THAT MATTERED**
>
> Carrying the work myself kept the society alive but made it entirely dependent on one person. I treated that as a temporary fix with a deadline, not a solution. The permanent fix was to pick specific juniors, teach them each task directly, and let them own it while I checked the output. Within a year that check step is all I do.

Problem 2: two members who held positions without doing the work

Shanu: a founding member and a friend

Shanu was part of PPGS from the start. Over time he stopped contributing and stopped responding to work. Removing him was the harder of the two decisions because it had a personal cost I could not avoid: he was a friend, and I knew the friendship would take damage.

I removed him anyway. The reasoning I used was that a position occupied by someone not doing the work is worse than a vacancy. It blocks a replacement and it signals to everyone else that the standard is optional. I raised it with the rest of the team rather than doing it unilaterally, and the team supported the decision.

Vishal Mandal: recruited on a referral

Vishal Mandal joined through a recommendation from a friend of mine. He showed little interest in the actual work and appeared to want the title more than the responsibility. He was removed as well.

The lesson I took from this one is about intake, not exit: I had accepted him on the strength of a personal referral rather than on any evidence of what he would actually do. The interview process introduced later in the year exists partly because of this.

What these two situations produced

- **A stated standard.** Holding a title required delivering the function. This became explicit rather than assumed.
- **A screening step.** Later intake went through structured interviews instead of referral and enthusiasm.
- **A cost I accepted knowingly.** I was not neutral about removing a friend. I decided the organisation's ability to function outranked my comfort, and I would make the same call again.

05 · FROM FOUNDER-LED TO SYSTEM-LED

Removing myself from the critical path

The single result I would most want examined in an interview.

A society that only works when the founder is in the room has not been built. It has been performed. The progression below was deliberate, took about a year, and is the reason PPGS still publishes when I am unavailable.

STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	STAGE 5	STAGE 6
I did the work	**I picked who could take it**	**I taught the task**	**They executed**	**I reviewed**	**The gate became optional**
Direct execution across posting, coordination, permissions and events when contribution collapsed.	Selected specific juniors on demonstrated reliability, not on availability or eagerness.	Walked each person through the actual work rather than describing the outcome and hoping.	Ownership transferred. They produced; I stopped producing.	Final quality check before anything went out. My role narrowed to a gate, not a workstation.	Third years now verify and publish when I am unavailable. The system no longer waits on me.

The workflow that resulted

The society now runs a three-layer publishing and delivery process across academic years:

Second year: implementation	Produces the content or executes the task
Third year: review and management	Checks the work, manages the batch below, escalates only what needs it
Final verification: me, when available	If I am unavailable, third years verify and publish without me

> **WHY THIS IS THE IMPORTANT PART**
>
> Anyone can point at events they organised. Far fewer can point at an operation that kept running after they stepped back from it. My involvement today is limited to oversight, permissions that require a senior signature, and major event decisions. That reduction is the intended outcome, not a decline in commitment.

Succession structure

The chapter began as a single-batch organisation, which is the standard failure mode for student societies: the founding batch graduates and the society dies with it. Recruiting the incoming batch before my final year created overlapping layers: a batch executing, a batch managing, and a batch preparing to manage. Membership currently stands at roughly 40 across academic years, with a further intake expected when the new first-year batch joins. INTERNAL

06 · EVENT CASE 1

Debatocracy: debate competition

13 September 2025 · Annex Building, HIT Haldia · the society's first public test.

~100	~25	13	2	3
Students reached in promotion	Registrations at ₹9 fee	Students who competed on the day	Faculty judges	Winners declared
INTERNAL	INTERNAL / POSTER	INTERNAL	OFFICIAL REPORT	OFFICIAL REPORT

Format

Topics were released 25 minutes before each round. Debate positions and opponents were assigned randomly to keep it fair. Each round ran to a 15-minute structure of three minutes of argument and three minutes of rebuttal from the opposing side, with winners advancing until a final three were declared. Judges: Mainak Chanda and Deepti Yellanki. Winners: Ashifa, Sambit, Aryaveer. REPORT

The problem on the day

Registration did not convert. Roughly 25 students registered; 13 turned up to compete. At that point the options were to postpone, to cancel, or to run a competition visibly smaller than advertised.

> **DECISION**
>
> We ran it. A cancelled first event would have told the campus that PPGS could not deliver, and would have cost us the two faculty judges who had given up their time. A small event that actually happened produced photographs, a published record, three winners, and a faculty relationship. A cancelled event would have produced nothing.

My role versus the team's

Mine: event coordination on the day, promotion, faculty approach for judging, and the decision to proceed at reduced turnout. I also led the sponsorship conversation described in Section 8.

Team's: junior members handled classroom-level operations and participant management; several batchmates handled logistics including refreshments; Amrita and the media group produced the posters and instruction cards.



Registration collateral. Fee of ₹9 and QR registration visible. The events ran on a paid-registration model from the first one.



Prize distribution by the faculty judges. Faculty participation was secured for the society's first ever event.

DATA NOTE: PARTICIPATION FIGURE

The official PPGS Report v1.4 records "30+ participants" for Debatocracy. My own account is that 13 students competed. These are reconciled here as **13 competing debaters within a room of roughly 30 people**, the wider figure including organisers and attendees present. That reconciliation is mine and is not separately documented. The event photograph shows approximately 25 people.

What it taught us

- **Registration is a weak signal.** A ₹9 fee was not enough commitment to guarantee attendance. Promotion reach had to be widened, not just registration counted.
- **Delivering something small beats delivering nothing.** The published record from this event is what made the second event easier to promote and easier to sponsor.

07 · EVENT CASE 2

Voice of Ideas: extempore competition

29 March 2026 · Annex Building, HIT Haldia · built specifically to fix the turnout problem.

The brief we set ourselves

Debatocracy's failure point was the gap between promotion and attendance. For Voice of Ideas the objective was explicitly to widen the top of the funnel rather than hope for better conversion: roughly double the promotion reach, and promote where students actually are rather than only where it is convenient.

What changed operationally

- **Hostel outreach.** Direct promotion inside hostels, which reaches students outside class hours and outside their department bubble.
- **Classroom promotion with permission.** Faculty approval obtained to pitch in class, a channel we did not have consistently for the first event.
- **Direct approach.** One-to-one conversations rather than relying on posters and Instagram alone.
- **Higher fee.** ₹19 versus ₹9, tested against a larger promotion base. VISUAL

~200 students reached in promotion — INTERNAL

~60 registrations at ₹19 — INTERNAL

~40 participants on the day — INTERNAL · see data note below

DATA NOTE: PARTICIPATION FIGURE. READ THIS BEFORE QUOTING IT

My internal records give approximately 60 registrations and approximately 40 participants. **The official PPGS Report v1.4 records "10–15" participants for this event.** The two sources disagree materially and I have chosen to present my own figures, with the official figure printed here rather than removed.

Anyone verifying this should be aware that the official report and the published event photograph do not support the higher figure on their own. The most likely explanation is that the report records a narrower definition, for example finalists or a single round, than my count of everyone who competed across the event.

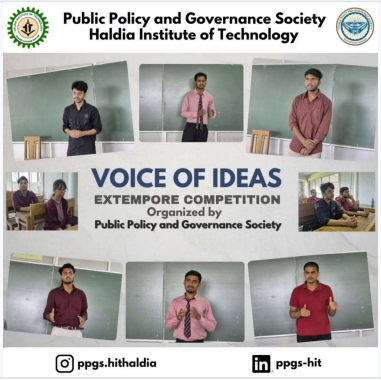
Format and judging

Topics were announced on the spot with one minute of preparation, delivered in English, no electronic devices permitted. Participants were assessed on clarity of thought, confidence, content, language and presentation. Winners: Roman Quamar, Aditya, Prakit Raj.

REPORT

A constraint we had to solve live

No faculty judges were available for this event. Rather than postpone, I judged alongside selected third-year members, three of us in total. The official report records the judging panel as "Club Members", which is consistent with this. An internal panel is less credible than a faculty panel, and a future edition should book judges before registration opens.



Voice of Ideas: participants delivering extempore speeches, 29 March 2026. Published to the society's Instagram.



Group photograph published as event collateral.

The outcome that actually mattered

RECOGNITION IS NOT FOLLOWER COUNT

Instagram following did not grow meaningfully across this period. Recognition inside the college did. Students knew what PPGS was and associated it with debate and speaking events; faculty who already knew me began to know me through PPGS specifically. Social media metrics are not presented as evidence of impact anywhere in this document.

08 · SPONSORSHIP & LOCAL PARTNERSHIPS

Two deals, structured as exchanges rather than requests

Both events were externally funded. Neither was funded by asking for a donation.

A new society has no budget and no track record, which makes the usual pitch of "please support our event" worth very little. The approach I used instead was to work out what the business wanted, work out what a student event could actually deliver against that, and propose the exchange.

PARTNERSHIP 1

Debatocracy

PARTNER

A newly opened local food business

WHAT THEY GAVE

In-kind: food packets, approximately matched to the number of people being catered for at the event

WHAT WE GAVE

Discount coupons distributed to eligible participants, approximately 20% off the customer's bill, valid for roughly one week

WHAT THEY WERE BUYING

Trial and awareness. The outlet was new and needed first-time customers and local visibility

WHY THE STRUCTURE WORKED FOR THEM

The discount was proportional to spend, so a redeeming group had to place a real order to benefit. Short validity concentrated the traffic

RESULT DATA

No redemption tracking was put in place. We do not know how many coupons were used or what the business earned

PARTNERSHIP 2

Voice of Ideas

PARTNER

A local coffee shop

WHAT THEY GAVE

₹10,000 in direct cash sponsorship

WHAT WE GAVE

A dedicated promotional reel produced by our media team, plus coupon distribution to event participants (two coffees ordered, one complimentary mini snack)

WHAT THEY WERE BUYING

Access to a student audience, produced social content they did not have to make, and a mechanism to convert attendees into footfall

EXECUTION

~60 coupons prepared against registrations; ~40 distributed to attendees; ~20 unused

RESULT DATA

No redemption tracking. Distribution is known; conversion is not

How the conversation was actually run

I handled the outreach personally, going to the businesses in person with two junior members. The sequence I used each time:

01
Establish what we were
What the event was, when, where, and what it involved.

02
Define the audience
Who would be in the room, and why that audience is relevant to a shop near campus.

03
Name their objective
A new outlet needs trial. An established one needs repeat footfall. The offer differed accordingly.

04
State what we could deliver
Coupon distribution into a captive audience, produced content, branded association with the event.

05
Propose the exchange
Specific ask, specific deliverable, no open-ended goodwill request.

06
Deliver what was promised
Reel produced, coupons printed and distributed on the day.

LIMITS OF THIS SECTION

Outcomes were not measured for either partner: no redemption rate, no customer-acquisition count, no revenue figure. What is known is that both deals were structured around a stated commercial objective and both were delivered as agreed.

Neither sponsorship appears in the official PPGS report. Both are documented here from my own records. INTERNAL

What this is evidence of

Cold outreach to a business with no prior relationship; identifying the other party's commercial objective before pitching; designing an offer against that objective instead of a generic sponsorship tier; negotiating an in-kind deal when cash was not available and a cash deal when it was; and delivering the promised promotion afterwards. In commercial terms this is early-stage partnership and business development work, at small scale and without measurement.

09 · EXTERNAL REPRESENTATION

Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur

21–22 March 2026 · sole representative of PPGS and Haldia Institute of Technology. REPORT

How I got there

The opportunity came through the IIT Kharagpur network. I applied via Unstop and cleared the first selection round. I asked members of the society to apply with me; they were committed to their own projects and did not. I went alone and represented the college on my own.

What I did on site

I was assigned the role of Yogi Adityanath within the simulated parliament. Beyond speaking my own part, I took on coordination for the bloc I was placed in, working alongside participants assigned the Prime Minister and other senior roles:

- Created and administered the WhatsApp group used to coordinate the bloc
- Sequenced who would speak, when, and on what, before the session rather than during it
- Handled communication and planning across the group through both days

Nobody appointed me to that. I picked it up because the coordination was not happening otherwise.



Speaking at Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur. VISUAL



The session floor. Participants drawn from multiple institutions.

When the event did not run as planned

The organisers' schedule broke down. Components were cut, including Zero Hour, and speaking opportunities that participants had prepared for did not materialise for everyone. I adjusted the bloc's sequencing to the reduced schedule and made sure I used the slot I did get. My speech was delivered and went well.

> WHAT CAME OUT OF IT
>
> **Relationship:** direct working contact with the IIT Kharagpur PPGS leadership, which is the network the HIT chapter depends on. **Institutional:** the official report records the representation and the proposal it generated, bringing a Sansad-format youth parliament to the HIT campus. **Personal:** the first time I had operated in a multi-institution environment rather than my own campus.



Certificate presented to faculty on return. The representation was formally recorded by the institute and published by the society. REPORT VISUAL

Honest scope

This was participation in a simulation, not a policy role. What it evidences: selection through a competitive first round, willingness to represent the institution without a group to hide in, self-directed coordination of a team of strangers, public speaking to an unfamiliar audience, and adapting when the agenda changed.

10 · RECRUITMENT & CONTINUITY

Building the next layer after our main channel was closed

The society's survival depended on recruiting a batch we were not allowed to address in person.

The problem

Entering my fourth year meant the founding cohort would graduate within a year. Unless the incoming batch was recruited and trained first, PPGS would end with us. The intake had to happen on a fixed deadline.

Our most reliable recruitment channel, classroom promotion, was not approved this time. That removed the method that had produced most of the original team.

The alternative

Rather than treating the refusal as a blocker, we moved recruitment to the channel students actually use. We produced a collaborative Instagram reel featuring six members of the society, published as a collab so it surfaced across all six accounts rather than one.

~5,000 organic views on the recruitment reel — No paid promotion INTERNAL

~150 interview registrations — INTERNAL

Selected intake across two year groups — Structured interviews INTERNAL

The selection process

I planned and ran the interview process together with a friend and members of the year below. Interviews were conducted rather than positions handed out, a direct response to having previously admitted a member on a referral who did not contribute.

The primary target was first-year students, since they would carry the society for the longest. Some second-year students who applied were strong enough to select as well, which had a structural benefit: it created a middle layer immediately rather than leaving a one-year gap between the founding batch and the newest one.

THE POINT OF THIS SECTION

The interesting part is not the view count. It is that a channel we depended on was withdrawn on a deadline, and the response was to switch channels rather than to escalate or wait. The replacement channel produced roughly 150 applicants for a society that had existed for less than a year.

Handover

With the new intake in place, operational responsibility moved down a layer. Where a specific person was no longer available, the function was reassigned rather than left vacant. For example, Parag took over the operational deputy work Anshu had been carrying. Membership now stands at roughly 40 across academic years, with a further first-year intake expected on joining. The founding fourth-year batch was given a farewell and positions were formally reassigned for the 2026–27 session. INTERNAL

11 · CONTRIBUTION SPLIT

What I did, what the team did, what I did not do

Holding the President title does not entitle me to credit for everything the society produced. This section separates it.

AREA	MY DIRECT CONTRIBUTION	OWNED OR SHARED BY OTHERS
Founding	Co-founded the HIT chapter; contributed to the approach and pitch to the IIT Kharagpur team; helped secure permission	Subid Thakur was the main founder and led the initiative; senior members lent institutional standing
Recruitment	Recruited the founding third-year cohort personally through direct conversations, network and class promotion; designed and ran the later interview process	Subid recruited the fourth-year names; the year below co-ran the interview panel
Team design	Mapped each member to a function based on their existing strength; reassigned functions when people left	Members owned and ran their functions independently once assigned
Operations	Ran the society directly for roughly a month when contribution collapsed; trained successors; held final review on output	Deepak and Shivam ran permissions and turnout; Anshu covered functions in my absence
Events	Coordinated Debatocracy on the day; decided to proceed at low turnout; designed the promotion strategy for Voice of Ideas; judged Voice of Ideas	Junior members ran classroom operations and participant management; batchmates handled logistics and refreshments; two other third years judged alongside me
Sponsorship	Led outreach to both businesses in person; designed the value exchange and negotiated both deals	Two junior members accompanied me; Anand's business network opened doors; media team produced the promised reel
External relations	Sole liaison with the IIT Kharagpur PPGS team and with college faculty; sole representative at Sansad 2K26	Not applicable
Content and media	Final quality check before publication; topic direction	**Not mine.** Design, video editing and content production were done by Amrita, Dhruv, Alysha and Adnan. Research by Vishal Kumar
Finance	Secured the funds	**Not mine.** Fee collection, sponsorship funds and event spend were handled by Anwesha Kumari
Succession	Designed the three-layer workflow; trained the layer below; withdrew from execution deliberately	Third and second years now run the workflow day to day

WHERE I WAS GENUINELY THE BOTTLENECK, AND WHERE I WAS NOT

External relationships, sponsorship, recruitment and the decision to keep going when the team stalled were mine, and the society would not have had them otherwise. Design, video, research and financial handling were not mine.

12 · OUTCOMES

Every number, with its source

Nothing in this table is presented without stating where it comes from and how firm it is.

RESULT	FIGURE	SOURCE	CONFIDENCE
Competitive events delivered end-to-end	**2**	REPORT Documented	High. Dated, judged, winners named, published
External institutional representation	**1**	REPORT VISUAL	High. Dated, certificated, photographed
Core committee constituted, 2026–27	**12**	REPORT	High. Named in the official report
Founding cohort recruited	**~14**	INTERNAL	Medium. Consistent with 12 committee members after two removals
Current membership across year groups	**~40**	INTERNAL	Medium. Approximate, not a maintained register
Applicants to the recruitment drive	**~150**	INTERNAL	Medium. Registration count, approximate
Organic views on recruitment reel	**~5,000**	INTERNAL	Medium. Platform figure, no screenshot retained
Cash sponsorship secured	**₹10,000**	INTERNAL	Medium. Not in the official report
In-kind sponsorship secured	**1 deal**	INTERNAL	Medium. Quantity of food packets approximate
Students reached, Debatocracy promotion	**~100**	INTERNAL	Low to medium. Estimate
Students reached, Voice of Ideas promotion	**~200**	INTERNAL	Low to medium. Estimate
Debatocracy participation	**13 / 30+**	INTERNAL vs REPORT	**Disputed.** 13 competing debaters; report records 30+ participants. See Section 6
Voice of Ideas participation	**~40 / 10–15**	INTERNAL vs REPORT	**Disputed.** Report records 10–15. See Section 7
Coupon redemptions, either partnership	**Not measured**	Not applicable	No data was collected
Instagram follower growth	**Not material**	INTERNAL	Explicitly not claimed as an outcome

Qualitative outcomes I would defend in an interview

- **The society exists and functions without me in the loop.** This is verifiable by asking anyone currently running it.
- **A recognised campus identity was built within one year.** Students and faculty associate PPGS with debate and speaking events. Recognition, not follower count.
- **External funding was secured twice by a first-year organisation with no track record.**

- **The founding batch's graduation is no longer an extinction event** for the society, because two junior layers were recruited and trained before it.

13 · CAPABILITIES EVIDENCED

Each claim, and the specific thing behind it

If a line below has no example attached to it, it does not belong in this document.

CAPABILITY	SPECIFIC EVIDENCE IN THIS CASE STUDY
Building from zero	Chapter founded with no members, budget, precedent or faculty relationship. All of it was assembled within one academic year.
Persuasion	Convinced already-committed students to take on a second set of responsibilities for an organisation with no track record, by reframing the offer as ownership and access rather than membership.
Partnership & sponsorship	Two deals closed with local businesses through in-person cold outreach: one in-kind and one ₹10,000 cash, each structured around the partner's stated commercial objective.
Stakeholder management	Sole liaison with an external institution's leadership (IIT Kharagpur PPGS), college faculty for judging and permissions, and local business owners.
Team design	Eleven members mapped to functions on the basis of demonstrated strength; a deputy deliberately positioned to cover my absence.
Performance management	Two members removed for non-contribution, one a personal friend and founding member, with the decision taken openly rather than unilaterally.
Operating under failure	Society carried single-handedly for roughly a month when contribution collapsed, instead of allowing it to go dormant.
Training & delegation	Successors taught the tasks directly, then given ownership, with a review gate that was progressively removed.
Process design	Three-layer workflow across academic years: implement, review, verify, with an explicit path for publishing when I am unavailable.
Event delivery	Two competitions run end-to-end: promotion, paid registration, judging panel, execution, prize distribution, published record.
Decision-making under pressure	Ran Debatocracy at half the expected turnout rather than cancelling; ran Voice of Ideas judging with an internal panel when faculty were unavailable.
Channel problem-solving	Classroom recruitment refused; switched to a collaborative Instagram reel that produced roughly 150 applicants.
Public speaking	Represented the institution at Sansad 2K26, IIT Kharagpur, delivering a speech to a multi-institution audience after clearing a competitive selection round.
Succession planning	Recruited and trained two junior layers before the founding batch's final year, converting a single-batch society into a multi-year structure.

WHAT THIS DOES NOT EVIDENCE

Managing paid staff. Owning a P&L. Formal project management tooling. Data analysis or measurement discipline. Policy expertise, despite the society's subject matter. Anything at organisational scale beyond roughly 40 volunteer members.

14 · ASSESSMENT

What I got wrong, where it stands, what is planned

What I would do differently

WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT I WOULD CHANGE
Founder dependency. The society ran on my effort for its first term and would have stopped if I had.	Build the review-and-train layer from the start, not after the collapse. The fix worked; it should not have taken a failure to trigger it.
Intake on referral. A member admitted on a personal recommendation contributed nothing and had to be removed.	Screen on evidence of contribution from the beginning. The interview process introduced later should have existed at founding.
Registration treated as attendance. Debatocracy lost roughly half its registrants on the day.	Treat a paid registration as a weak signal, confirm attendance close to the date, and size the promotion base accordingly.
No measurement on sponsorship. Neither partner has a redemption rate, footfall figure or return.	Agree one measurable with the partner up front, even a manual coupon count at the counter, so the next deal can be sold on results.
Judging booked late. Voice of Ideas ran with an internal panel because no faculty judge was available.	Confirm the panel before registration opens. Internal judging weakens the result even when the event runs well.
Inconsistent record-keeping. Official participation figures and internal recollection now disagree for both events.	Record attendance on the day, in writing, against a register. This document carries two flagged discrepancies purely because that was not done.

Current status

Organisation. PPGS HIT operates with a twelve-member core committee for the 2026–27 session and roughly 40 members across academic years. Day-to-day production and review sit with the third- and second-year layers. REPORT INTERNAL

My role. President for 2026–27, operating in oversight. In practice: final verification when I am available, senior-level permissions, meetings with faculty and the IIT Kharagpur team, and decisions on major events. I am no longer in the production path, by design.

Planned, not delivered

The following are scheduled or proposed initiatives recorded in the official report. They are listed for completeness and are **not** presented as achievements.

INITIATIVE	STATUS	DESCRIPTION AS RECORDED IN THE OFFICIAL REPORT
Drishtikon	PLANNED 23 Aug 2026	A policy-based debate in which participants defend opposing viewpoints and attempt to persuade each other to reconsider their stance. Intended to strengthen persuasion and critical thinking.
Turn Your Court	PLANNED undated	An extempore format in which participants argue both for and against the same public policy within a single round. Intended to build balanced analysis and adaptability.
Vision to Service	PLANNED undated	An interactive session with an invited speaker on leadership, governance and career opportunities in public service.
Sansad at HIT	PROPOSED	A youth-parliament format on the HIT campus, proposed following the IIT Kharagpur representation and recorded in the official report as a resulting initiative.

15 · CLOSING

What this experience actually demonstrates

In one academic year I helped start an organisation that did not exist, staffed it, kept it alive through the point where it nearly stopped, funded two of its events through partnerships I negotiated myself, represented it outside the institution, recruited its

replacement generation after our main recruitment channel was closed, and then removed myself from its day-to-day operation on purpose.

The scale is a student society of roughly forty volunteers, and I am not going to inflate that. What transfers is the sequence: identify an unmet need, persuade people to commit before there is proof, build a structure around what people are actually good at, hold a standard when it costs you personally, get external parties to fund you by giving them something they want, and then design the operation so it survives your departure.

The last item is the one I would ask to be judged on. Most people who run something can point at what happened while they were there. The result I am putting forward is what kept happening after I stepped back.

APPENDIX

Sources and data notes

Sources used

- **PPGS Report v1.4**: the society's official report for AY 2025–26, submitted to Haldia Institute of Technology. Source for dates, event formats, judges, winners, committee composition, the IIT Kharagpur representation, and all planned initiatives.
- **Event collateral and published posts**: posters, instruction cards and photographs published on the society's Instagram (ppgs.hithaldia) and LinkedIn (ppgs-hit). Source for registration fees, dates, venue and visual evidence.
- **Founder's internal account**: my own records and recollection. Source for team formation, role allocation, personnel decisions, promotion reach, sponsorship terms, recruitment campaign figures and current membership. Not independently documented.

Open discrepancies

1 · VOICE OF IDEAS PARTICIPATION

Official report: **10–15 participants.** My records: **~60 registrations, ~40 participants.** This document presents my figures. The gap is material and unresolved. A reader verifying against the official report or the published photograph will not find support for the higher number on its own.

2 · DEBATOCRACY PARTICIPATION

Official report: **30+ participants.** My records: **~25 registrations, 13 competing on the day.** Presented here as 13 competing debaters within a room of roughly 30 people including organisers and attendees. That reconciliation is mine and is not separately documented.

3 · SEQUENCING

My recollection placed the IIT Kharagpur representation after Voice of Ideas. The official report dates the representation 21–22 March 2026 and Voice of Ideas 29 March 2026. The report's dates are used throughout this document.

4 · UNMEASURED ITEMS

Coupon redemption, customer acquisition and commercial return for both sponsors were not tracked and are not claimed anywhere in this document. Promotion reach figures for both events are estimates. The recruitment reel view count and current membership figure are approximate and not screenshotted or registered.

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